

Liora Nightingale

Character Dossier

Dreamy and forgetful quartermaster of the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon

Overview

Liora Nightingale is a quartermaster living in the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon. Liora is 22 years old, originally from Two Rivers, and is known around the Reading Well as dreamy and forgetful. In conversation Liora never uses contractions and apologises for it.

Background

Liora arrived in the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon 2 years ago after leaving Two Rivers under circumstances Liora describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Order of Wet Pages; the second was the one that stuck. Today Liora works as a quartermaster near the Stacks of Ash and is paid, when paid at all, in ink-weights.

Liora learned the trade from Torvald Nightingale, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Liora's life is with Ravi Castellan, over a matter neither will explain. The person Liora trusts most is Tallulah Hartwell.

Current goal: to find out what happened to the missing caravan. Greatest fear: being forgotten.

Personality and speech

Temperament: dreamy and forgetful.

Speech pattern: Liora never uses contractions and apologises for it.

Tells: when lying, Liora mentions Vesper the hedgehog for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Liora Nightingale
Role	quartermaster
Home	the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon
Hometown	Two Rivers
Age	22
Favourite dish	cold crab bisque
Pet	Vesper, a hedgehog
Lucky number	230

<i>Workshop password</i>	velvet-oak
<i>Mentor</i>	Torvald Nightingale
<i>Rival</i>	Ravi Castellan
<i>Closest friend</i>	Tallulah Hartwell

Secret

Liora has never told Torvald Nightingale that the famous 'accident' was deliberate.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Liora: I am the quartermaster. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Liora: Cold crab bisque. Do not tell Ravi I said so.

Visitor: Is Vesper yours?

Liora: Vesper belongs to nobody. Vesper tolerates me. Lucky number is 230, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, winter of year 11

The weather turned. Liora moved the spool of wire indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the quarantine. The weather turned. Liora moved the cracked compass indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew. A dispute over the tariff on salt flared up between Liora and a neighbour outside the Reading Well; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Liora spent the day counting stock at the Reading Well: 14 of everything, except the grain scale, which is always short. The weather turned. Liora moved the tin whistle indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tariff on salt.

Entry 2, summer of year 11

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the sluice gates. Liora pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Liora moved the ledger indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the price of lamp oil.

Entry 3, spring of year 11

Someone left a bundle of letters on the doorstep with no note. Liora has a suspect and is probably right. Liora won 65 ink-weights on a bet about the old tunnels and spent all of it on supper. Liora repaired the pair of spectacles at the cataloguers' gallery for Zora, who paid in 59 ink-weights and a long story about the old tunnels. Liora found a hand bell half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 4, winter of year 11

A stranger asked Liora for the password to the workshop. Liora laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Liora and a neighbour outside the Reading Well; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the Reading Well, Liora taught a newcomer how to tell a real wax seal from a fake one by weight alone. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Liora read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Liora was hired to carry a cracked compass from the Reading Well to the sluice gates without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 5, spring of year 11

the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Liora read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Liora spent the day counting stock at the cataloguers' gallery: 61 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. Liora was hired to carry a coil of rope from the cataloguers' gallery to the sluice gates without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 6, summer of year 11

Liora was hired to carry a hand bell from the Stacks of Ash to the cataloguers' gallery without opening it, and mostly succeeded. At the Stacks of Ash, Liora taught a newcomer how to tell a real clockwork bird from a fake one by weight alone. The weather turned. Liora moved the coil of rope indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tax on doors.

Entry 7, summer of year 11

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. Liora spent the day counting stock at the Reading Well: 9 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the Reading Well. Liora pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over the tariff on salt flared up between Liora and a neighbour outside the Reading Well; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 8, summer of year 11

Liora repaired the wax seal at the sluice gates for Wilhelmina, who paid in 18 ink-weights and a long story about the tax on doors. Liora won 90 ink-weights on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on supper. Liora was hired to carry a ledger from the sluice gates to the Reading Well without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 9, summer of year 12

Rumours about the harvest count reached the cataloguers' gallery. Liora pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Liora for the password to the workshop. Liora laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over the tariff on salt flared up between Liora and a neighbour outside the cataloguers' gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Liora won 38 ink-weights on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 10, summer of year 12

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. Liora found a brass lantern half-buried near the sluice gates and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Liora spent the day counting stock at the sluice gates: 25 of everything, except the bundle of letters, which is always short.

Entry 11, winter of year 12

Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Liora has a suspect and is probably right. Viggo came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Liora said nothing useful and made tea instead. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 12, autumn of year 12

Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached the Stacks of Ash. Liora pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Liora spent the day counting stock at the Stacks of Ash: 38 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short. Liora spent the day counting stock at

the Stacks of Ash: 3 of everything, except the brass lantern, which is always short. Rumours about the census reached the Stacks of Ash. Liora pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 13, winter of year 13

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. Liora won 40 ink-weights on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on supper. Someone left a oilskin map on the doorstep with no note. Liora has a suspect and is probably right. Fenwick came by asking about the missing shipment. Liora said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the Stacks of Ash. Liora pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 14, spring of year 13

the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Liora read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before. Liora spent the day counting stock at the sluice gates: 59 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short. Someone left a bundle of letters on the doorstep with no note. Liora has a suspect and is probably right. Liora was hired to carry a grain scale from the sluice gates to the Archivist's cell without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 15, autumn of year 13

At the cataloguers' gallery, Liora taught a newcomer how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Liora read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Liora was hired to carry a tin whistle from the cataloguers' gallery to the Reading Well without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Amadou came by asking about the singing at the docks. Liora said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 16, summer of year 13

Someone left a spool of wire on the doorstep with no note. Liora has a suspect and is probably right. Liora won 85 ink-weights on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on supper. Liora closed early, walked to the Archivist's cell, and watched the lights come on. Liora found a glass float half-buried near the Stacks of Ash and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 17, winter of year 13

Liora was hired to carry a glass float from the Stacks of Ash to the cataloguers' gallery without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Quillon came by asking about the missing shipment. Liora said nothing useful and made tea instead. A stranger asked Liora for the password to the workshop. Liora laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 18, summer of year 13

A stranger asked Liora for the password to the workshop. Liora laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the old tunnels reached the Archivist's cell. Liora pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. At the Archivist's cell, Liora taught a

newcomer how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 19, summer of year 13

the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the harvest count. Liora read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Liora and a neighbour outside the cataloguers' gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Liora won 85 ink-weights on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on supper. Liora closed early, walked to the Archivist's cell, and watched the lights come on. Liora repaired the coil of rope at the cataloguers' gallery for Benedikt, who paid in 73 ink-weights and a long story about the census.

Entry 20, spring of year 13

Liora spent the day counting stock at the cataloguers' gallery: 86 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short. Liora found a bolt of linen half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Liora was hired to carry a bolt of linen from the cataloguers' gallery to the sluice gates without opening it, and mostly succeeded.